

Compensation Bands 2026

Owner: Sofia Marques, Head of People **Approved by:** Maya Okafor (CEO) and Daniel Reyes (CFO) on 27 January 2026 **Effective:** 1 March 2026 (annual compensation cycle) **Classification:** HR Confidential. Do not share outside the People team.

1. Principles

- Northwind Labs pays base salary within a band defined per job family, level and location zone. Bands are reviewed once a year against benchmark data (Radford and Ravigo, 50th to 65th percentile).
- The midpoint represents a fully competent employee at that level. New hires are normally offered between the band minimum and the midpoint.
- Offers above the midpoint require approval by the Head of People; offers above the band maximum require approval by the CEO.
- Bands are expressed as annual gross base salary. Sales roles show on-target earnings (OTE) separately.

2. Location zones

Zone	Locations	Currency
Zone A	Austin and US remote	USD
Zone B	Berlin and Germany remote	EUR
Zone C	Lisbon and Portugal remote	EUR
Zone D	Kraków and Poland remote	EUR (paid in PLN at the monthly rate)

3. Levels

Engineering levels run from L1 (Associate) to L7 (Principal). Go-to-market levels run from S1 to S5. Managers use M1 to M4.

4. Engineering bands (Software Engineer job family)

Level	Zone	Minimum	Midpoint	Maximum
L2 Software Engineer	Zone A (Austin)	\$112,000	\$128,000	\$144,000
L2 Software Engineer	Zone C (Lisbon)	€42,000	€49,000	€56,000
L3 Software Engineer II	Zone A (Austin)	\$132,000	\$150,000	\$168,000
L3 Software Engineer II	Zone C (Lisbon)	€52,000	€60,000	€68,000
L4 Senior Software Engineer	Zone A (Austin)	\$158,000	\$178,000	\$198,000
L4 Senior Software Engineer	Zone B (Berlin)	€78,000	€88,000	€98,000
L4 Senior Software Engineer	Zone C (Lisbon)	€64,000	€73,000	€82,000
L4 Senior Software Engineer	Zone D (Kraków)	€58,000	€66,000	€74,000
L5 Staff Engineer	Zone A (Austin)	\$186,000	\$208,000	\$230,000
L5 Staff Engineer	Zone C (Lisbon)	€80,000	€91,000	€102,000

5. Sales bands (base salary and OTE)

Level	Zone	Base minimum	Base maximum	OTE at midpoint	Pay mix
S2 Sales Development Rep	Zone A	\$58,000	\$72,000	\$92,000	70/30
S3 Account Executive	Zone A	\$95,000	\$125,000	\$220,000	50/50
S3 Account Executive	Zone B	€70,000	€90,000	€160,000	55/45
S4 Senior Account Executive	Zone A	\$120,000	\$150,000	\$270,000	50/50
S5 Sales Director	Zone B	€115,000	€140,000	€230,000	60/40

6. Annual cycle 2026

- Merit budget: 3.5% of base payroll; promotion budget: 1.0%.
- Increases are effective 1 March 2026 and are processed in Workday.
- Employees rated "Exceeds" are eligible for up to 8% merit; "Meets" for up to 4%; "Partially meets" for 0%.